



Jaswinder Ahuja with family

and got the office building done. Similarly, I successfully handled the project for upgrading our entire IT infrastructure. I was always the go-to guy. If you needed something to be done, that nobody else was willing to do or there was nobody else to own it, then I would get it done. I think that mindset has helped me. I never said no to even any mundane operational tasks. I felt it's just a task to be done."

As Jaswinder proceeds in his leadership path, he focuses more on creating value and contributing to the success of his company, customers, and society. Thus, he ensures making an impact.

Jaswinder always preferred to be physically present with his parents. Therefore, he decided not to take the opportunity to be a member of the global management team at the corporate headquarter of Cadence as it needed relocation. However, he contributed to and led various global projects at Cadence, as and when required, leveraging his expertise in multiple functional areas as well as the ability to work

with culturally diverse workforces worldwide.

He keeps looking for opportunities to contribute in innovative ways. For example, he proposed and set up centralised R&D operations function at Cadence, led it for the next three years, and then handed it over to his successor. He took responsibility for Cadence Research & Development (R&D) Globalization program and managed various global collaborative R&D projects between Cadence and its major customers.

In 2008, Cadence went through a major period of turmoil globally,

and most of the senior executives, including the then-CEO, left the company and a new management team came on board. Jaswinder contributed to the rebuilding process. He says, "Our global HR head, Tina Jones, reached out to me to support her in employee engagement, and in redefining the company culture. So, I spent one year on an HR project. It was a wonderful, foundational experience. I learned a lot by doing that, as I got an opportunity to facilitate the transition of our new CEO."

Giving back to society

Jaswinder's belief in making an impact through contribution towards society makes him highly involved in the corporate social responsibility (CSR) initiatives of Cadence at a personal level. He explains, "We, at Cadence India, started our CSR initiatives long before the CSR law came into effect in the country. We formed our employee volunteer group called 'Make A Child Smile (MACS)' in 1997. Over the years, we've built schools and orphanages through company contributions, personal contributions, and employee contributions. We have a very active mentoring programme where our employees go and volunteer their time in mentoring orphans and underprivileged children."

To raise awareness and mobilize the corporate fraternity for the cause of child rights in India, Cadence

Some Favourites of Jaswinder

- **Favourite actor:** Amitabh Bachchan
- **Favourite actress:** Waheeda Rehman
- **Favourite music:** Old Hindi film songs, Gazals, and Jazz
- **Favourite singers:** Frank Sinatra in Western music, Mohammad Rafi and Farida Khanum in Indian music
- **Favourite food:** A food connoisseur who loves to try authentic local food whenever and wherever he travels. However, he has a soft corner for Awadhi cuisine.
- **Favourite film:** Godfather
- **Favourite pastimes:** Travelling, listening to music, hiking, swimming
- **Favourite book:** The Fountainhead by Ayn Rand